
The work before *the work.*

Every piece of software a trade contractor owns starts working the moment a job is won. Nothing works on the part before that — the quote nobody chased, the customer nobody called back, the crew with three empty days next week.

We are building the revenue operating system for that gap.

Category	Stage	Market	Date
AI Revenue OS for the Trades	Pre-seed concept	Australia first, then NZ · UK · CA · US	July 2026

A whole industry that is good at the work and bad at winning it

Trade businesses are founded by tradespeople, not salespeople. They can deliver almost anything they take on. What they cannot do — reliably, while standing on a roof — is respond in ten minutes, chase a quote on day seven, and notice that forty-one customers are due for service this month.

The owner is the bottleneck, and the bottleneck is structural rather than lazy. A burst pipe, a missing employee or an angry client gets attention immediately. A seven-day-old quote worth \$18,000 does not, because nothing in the business escalates it. Sales work is the only work with no deadline, so it moves to 9pm, and then to never.

The result is a business with a healthy top of funnel and a leaking middle. The money has already been spent to generate the enquiry. The site visit has already been driven to. The quote has already been written. And then it sits.

THE OBSERVATION THE COMPANY IS BUILT ON

Trade software has spent fifteen years solving the operational half of the business — scheduling, dispatch, timesheets, invoicing, compliance. All of it activates **after the job is won**. The commercial half — respond, qualify, follow up, reactivate, fill the calendar — was left to the owner's memory and spare time. That is where the money leaks, and that is the half nobody has productised for this customer.

Job-management software helps contractors organise the work they have won. We help them create, recover and convert the work they need next.

Seven leaks, all of them expensive, none of them visible

Contractors do not experience this as one problem. They experience it as seven small frustrations that never quite justify a solution on their own — which is exactly why the accumulated cost stays invisible.

THE LEAK	WHAT ACTUALLY HAPPENS
Slow response	An enquiry arrives at 10am. The owner is under a house. It is answered at 6pm, by which time a faster competitor has already booked the job.
Missed calls	The phone rings while driving, drilling or talking to another customer. Most callers never leave a voicemail — they just call the next name on the list.
Unchased quotes	Quotes are sent and abandoned. Owners forget, get busy, or feel uncomfortable appearing to chase. The customer reads it as disinterest.
Weak qualification	Half a day is lost driving to a job that was never going to be worth taking, because nobody asked four questions up front.
Forgotten customers	Ten years of customers sit in a database with no mechanism to notice that a service, a warranty, or a replacement is due.
Reactive capacity	Nobody sees the empty week until it is this week — far too late to generate demand for it.
No pipeline visibility	The owner cannot answer how much open work exists, why jobs are lost, or what next month looks like.

Why the obvious answer — "buy a CRM" — has already failed

Generic CRMs assume a user sitting at a desk who wants to build a pipeline. Trade owners are not that user, and the software's failure mode is predictable: it becomes a database nobody updates, then gets cancelled. Salesforce, HubSpot and Pipedrive are not too expensive for this market. They are too *empty*. They ask the busiest person in the business to do data entry as the price of getting value, and he will not.

WHAT THIS CUSTOMER WILL ACTUALLY ADOPT

- Mobile-first, usable between jobs
- Opinionated, not configurable
- Fed by existing systems, not manual entry
- Action lists, not record lists
- Plain trade language, no CRM jargon
- Useful in a four-minute session

The customer does not want a better database. He wants more profitable work in the calendar.

Start with the money that is already inside the business

The temptation is to launch the whole vision: AI receptionist, lead marketplace, tender portal, CRM. That is how this company dies. The first product does one thing, and it is chosen for how easily it can be proven.

AI quote follow-up and customer reactivation for established trade contractors.

We connect to the systems the contractor already runs, ingest their customers and open quotes, identify the revenue at risk, automate the follow-up that should have happened, and tell the owner exactly who needs a human phone call today.

Why this wedge and not a more exciting one

- **The lead is already paid for.** No argument about lead quality — it is their own customer.
- **The quote already exists.** Nothing to build, sell or generate first.
- **The loss is measurable.** We can quantify it before they buy and after they implement.
- **The workflow repeats weekly.** Habit forms, so retention has a mechanism.
- **It complements incumbents.** No rip-and-replace conversation in year one.
- **It is honest.** We are not promising leads we cannot control.

THE DELIBERATE DISCIPLINE

Cold lead generation, AI voice agents and tender intelligence are all in the long-term vision and all strategically defensible. None of them are the first proof point. Recovery is more credible, more controllable, and easier to attribute — and attribution is what earns the right to expand.

What it grows into

Once trust and ROI are established, the same system answers the full set of commercial questions a trade business cannot currently answer: where the next jobs come from, which leads to call first, which quotes will close, which customers are due, which crews will be idle, which commercial accounts to approach, and what revenue lands in the next 30, 60 and 90 days. That is the revenue operating system. The quote follow-up engine is simply the way in.

It opens with a decision, not a dashboard

The design principle is narrow and load-bearing: the home screen never shows records. It shows what to do, in order, with the reason attached. A contractor should get value from ninety seconds on a phone in a ute.

TODAY		Thursday · 5 actions · \$84,200 open pipeline
CALL NOW	Morrison Property Group — \$18,400	Viewed the quote three times this morning and opened the warranty document.
APPROVE	Follow-up to Liam Doherty — \$6,200	Quote expires Friday. No contact in nine days. Draft ready to send.
REVIEW	3 new enquiries collected overnight	All qualified and classified. One flagged commercial, high value.
CAMPAIGN	14 customers due for annual service	Estimated \$13,500–\$22,000. Awaiting your approval to send.
CAPACITY	Crew 2 has 1.5 open days next Thursday	11 deferred customers within 20km of Parramatta could fill it.

The five engines behind that screen

ENGINE	WHAT IT DOES
Quote follow-up Flagship	Sequences follow-up by quote value, customer type, urgency, age and engagement — then stops itself the moment the customer replies, the salesperson makes contact, the quote closes, or anything sensitive is detected.
Intent signals	Translates behaviour into one instruction. Not "lead score: 87" but "call today — they opened this three times and asked for your insurance certificate."
Reactivation	Reads service history for warranty expiry, seasonal cycles, compliance renewals, equipment age and deferred work, then builds small targeted campaigns instead of bulk mail-outs.
Capacity intelligence	Joins the sales pipeline to the crew calendar — the differentiator a generic CRM structurally cannot have. It knows not just what the pipeline is worth, but whether you have the people, skills and geography to deliver it.

Sales coach

Surfaces patterns from the customer's own data: quotes sent within 24 hours convert better; one estimator closes well but quotes slowly; jobs from this source carry low margin.

ON AI AUTONOMY — THE PART THAT PROTECTS THE BRAND

This product speaks to a contractor's customers in the contractor's name. A bad message costs more than a missed one. So automation is earned in four stages: **draft only**, then **approval queue**, then **guarded automation** within approved templates, and only then **advanced autonomy**. AI never sets price, offers discounts, invents a licence or makes a scope commitment. Every message is logged with who sent it, what data informed it, and whether a human approved it.

Integrate before replacing

ServiceM8, simPRO, AroFlo, Tradify, Fergus, Jobber and Xero remain the systems of record for jobs and money. We become the system of record for *growth* — engagement, follow-up strategy, revenue actions and attribution. That framing removes the switching cost that kills most new entrants into this market, and it means the incumbent's data makes our product better rather than making it redundant.

Big enough to matter, fragmented enough to enter

Australia's construction and trade-services economy is large, fragmented and unusually well suited to vertical SaaS: no dominant customer, high value per incremental job, repeatable workflows, and — critically — existing software adoption that gives us data to work with on day one.

3–30	\$750k–\$15m	20+	5 markets
Field employees in the target business	Annual revenue band	Meaningful quotes issued per month	Same problem in AU, NZ, UK, CA, US

"Tradies" is not a go-to-market

Every trade has different job values, urgency, repeat cycles and vocabulary. Entering broadly means speaking to nobody. We enter through one vertical where quote values are meaningful, quote volume is high enough to create measurable leakage, recurring service exists, and the data is already digital.

FIRST VERTICAL CANDIDATES	WHY IT FITS
HVAC & refrigeration Lead candidate	Seasonal demand, service intervals, maintenance plans, high-value replacements and commercial accounts — the strongest combination of recurring and recoverable revenue.
Commercial electrical	Project work plus maintenance contracts, compliance cycles and genuine commercial prospecting upside.
Multi-crew plumbing	High enquiry volume, emergency work, constant quoting and real capacity-management pain.
Fire protection	Servicing is recurring and compliance-driven — close to automatable renewal revenue.

Who we deliberately will not sell to yet

New sole traders, low-ticket operators where the subscription cannot be justified, cash-based businesses, anyone refusing digital systems, buyers who want guaranteed leads without doing sales work, and large enterprises requiring custom procurement before the product is mature. Each of these is a support burden and a churn statistic dressed as a customer.

Priced against the value of a job, not the number of seats

This product influences real revenue. Pricing it as a utility would weaken the positioning and starve the onboarding and support that this customer demonstrably needs.

TIER	AUD / MONTH	INCLUDED
Pilot	\$300 – \$750	Founder-led onboarding, revenue leak audit, manual-assisted delivery. Paid — never free.
Growth	\$499	Quote pipeline, automated follow-up, reactivation, AI prioritisation, standard integration, limited users.
Scale	\$999	Multiple teams, capacity intelligence, advanced automation and reporting, multiple integrations, commercial workflows.
Multi-branch	\$1,500 – \$3,000+	Multi-branch, account-based prospecting, tender intelligence, custom workflows, dedicated onboarding.

Layered on top: **metered usage** for SMS, voice, AI call minutes and data enrichment — which protects gross margin as AI costs move — and a **\$500–\$3,000 onboarding fee** for data cleanup, integration and campaign configuration. The onboarding fee is not a revenue line. It is a filter: customers who pay for implementation actually implement.

Why not outcome-based pricing

Charging a percentage of recovered revenue sounds perfectly aligned and creates permanent attribution disputes — the customer will always believe they would have won that job anyway, and sometimes they are right. Subscription first. A success fee is only defensible later, and only on opportunities we demonstrably *sourced* rather than assisted.

The value arithmetic

ILLUSTRATIVE MODEL — A REPRESENTATIVE GROWTH-TIER CUSTOMER

Quotes issued per month	40
Average quote value	\$5,000
Monthly quoted value	\$200,000
Current win rate	25%
Improvement from disciplined follow-up	+3 pts
Incremental booked revenue	\$6,000 / mo
At 35% gross margin	\$2,100 gross profit / mo
Subscription cost	\$499 – \$999 / mo

Illustrative arithmetic only, built from the assumptions above — not observed results. The company has no customers yet. Validating whether a three-point conversion lift is real, and repeatable, is the entire purpose of the concierge and pilot phases described in section 08.

The point of the model is not the specific number. It is the shape: **one recovered job pays for months of subscription**, which is what makes a \$499–\$999 price defensible to a business owner who is otherwise extremely price-sensitive about software.

Sell the diagnosis, not the software

Nobody in this market wants to buy an AI platform. They want to know what they are losing. So the product is not the first thing we sell — the audit is.

THE REVENUE LEAK AUDIT

A short, paid or low-cost engagement using the contractor's own exported quote and customer data. It quantifies open quote value, quotes with no follow-up, average response time, dormant customers eligible for reactivation, loss reasons and recurring-service potential.

"In the last 12 months you issued \$2.1 million in quotes. \$610,000 received no recorded follow-up. Recovering 5% of that is \$30,500 in additional work."

That single sentence does four jobs at once: it is the sales pitch, the qualification filter, the ROI baseline we will later measure against, and the onboarding data import. It is also nearly impossible to argue with, because it is built entirely from the contractor's own numbers.

Sequence

1. **Founder-led selling.** Direct, unscaled, deliberately. The point is learning which leak hurts most, what language lands, which integration is non-negotiable, and how much automation is trusted.
2. **5–10 pilots in one vertical.** Real data access, weekly feedback, agreed baseline metrics, and permission to build an anonymised case study.
3. **Case study, then channel.** A proven number in one vertical is the asset that makes every partner conversation work.

Channels, in order of leverage

CHANNEL	WHY IT WORKS
Job-management consultants	The people implementing ServiceM8, simPRO and AroFlo already have the trust and the customer list. We make their implementations look better.
Marketing agencies serving trades	Agencies get blamed when contractors fail to respond to the leads they generate. We fix their attribution problem — a genuinely aligned incentive.
Accountants & bookkeepers	They know precisely which clients are growing, disorganised or cash-constrained.

CHANNEL

WHY IT WORKS

Industry associations & wholesalers

Established distribution into large contractor networks.

Educational content

Quote follow-up scripts, response-time benchmarks, how to fill a slow month.
Content that is useful without the product builds the audience that buys it.

The demo

Always run on the prospect's own data. Show the neglected open quote value first — before any feature — then the priority queue, the safe follow-up sequence, the customers due for service, and the recovered-revenue report. The feature tour is the last thing they see, if they see it at all.

Earn the right to build it

This is a concept, not a company with traction. The plan is therefore designed to spend as little as possible before knowing whether the core claim — that systematic follow-up materially lifts conversion for this customer — is actually true.

STAGE	WHAT HAPPENS
1 • Interviews	30+ contractors across two verticals. Behavioural questions only — <i>show me your oldest open quote</i> , not <i>would you find this useful</i> .
2 • Concierge	Deliver the outcome manually for 3–5 paying customers. Import quotes, build campaigns, produce daily call lists, report recovered revenue. This is where the product design is actually discovered.
3 • Narrow pilot	Build only the workflows that repeated in the concierge stage. Nothing else.
4 • Paid beta	Convert to subscription. Praise without payment is not validation.

First 90 days

Days 1–15 • Select

Two candidate verticals, 15 interviews each, document workflows and software in use, identify the most valuable single leak.

Days 16–30 • Diagnose

Build the audit template. Run five real audits. Present findings and ask for payment to implement the recovery.

Days 31–60 • Deliver manually

Operate follow-up campaigns by hand with approval. Track outcomes. Measure revenue influenced and time saved.

Days 61–90 • Productise

Pick the highest-value repeated workflow, lock the first integration, build the narrow beta, convert pilots to subscription, publish the first case study.

PROCEED ONLY WHEN

- Customers grant real data access without being persuaded
- Several pay at the intended price point
- The system produces measurable, attributable outcomes
- Users continue the workflow after the novelty ends
- Onboarding repeats without founder heroics
- One vertical shows genuinely repeatable language and needs

The four that could actually kill this

Stated plainly, because a pitch that hides them is less credible than one that does not.

1. The incumbents simply build it

ServiceM8, simPRO, Jobber and AroFlo already hold the data and the customer relationship. Any of them could ship AI follow-up.

ANSWER This is the real risk, and it cannot be eliminated — only outrun and out-positioned. Our advantages are focus, speed, and being *cross-platform*: a contractor's data lives in a job system, an accounting system, an inbox and a calendar, and no single vendor is motivated to unify them. We are also building one thing while they maintain thirty. If the category proves out, acquisition by one of them is a legitimate outcome rather than a failure.

2. Automation damages a customer relationship

We are sending messages in the contractor's name to their customers. One badly timed message costs more trust than ten recovered quotes earn.

ANSWER Approval-first defaults, pause-on-reply, frequency caps, account exclusions, sensitive-issue detection and a full audit trail. Autonomy is a level the customer unlocks, never the default state.

3. Retention collapses after the backlog is cleared

The first ninety days recover a pile of neglected quotes. That is a one-off. If nothing recurring replaces it, the customer churns at month four having received exactly the value they paid for.

ANSWER This is why reactivation and capacity intelligence are in the product rather than the roadmap. Recovery wins the account; recurring service cycles and the empty-calendar problem are what make it a permanent system. Whether that holds is one of the questions the pilots must answer honestly.

4. The product sprawls

CRM, job management, marketing, AI calling, tenders, marketplace. Every one is a plausible adjacency and collectively they are fatal.

ANSWER The wedge is enforced structurally: no expansion without measurable evidence from the current stage. Tender intelligence in particular is explicitly a later module in a market that already has dedicated competitors.

The moat, honestly assessed

It is not "we use AI" — that will be commodity within two years. Defensibility, if it comes, comes from accumulation: deep trade-system integrations, proprietary structured revenue data, trade-specific playbooks, per-customer performance learning, the capacity-to-demand engine, credible outcome

attribution, and eventually anonymised cross-cohort benchmarks that no single contractor could ever generate alone. All of that compounds with usage. None of it exists on day one.

Why this, why now, why us

WHY THIS

Every trade software category was built for the operational half of the business. The commercial half is unserved, measurable, and worth more per customer.

WHY NOW

Job data is finally digital and API-accessible, and AI has made trade-specific qualification, drafting and prioritisation cheap enough to productise for a \$499 subscription.

WHY US

The founder has run a service company and built operational SaaS for one — direct knowledge of the gap between how software is designed and how frontline businesses actually behave.

We built this because we know what it is like to run a service business while trying to quote, follow up, schedule staff and keep work coming in. Most software starts after a job is won. We built the system we wanted before that point.

What the first product recovers

Nothing speculative. Open quotes. Unanswered enquiries. Previous customers. Deferred work. Recurring service cycles. Future crew capacity. All of it already sits inside the business, already paid for, currently leaking — which is precisely why the value can be proven rather than promised.

*The product wins when a contractor no longer depends on memory, spare time or late-night administration to **keep the pipeline moving**.*

The immediate ask is not capital. It is 30 contractor interviews, 5 revenue leak audits and 3 paid concierge customers in a single vertical — the cheapest possible test of whether disciplined follow-up moves conversion enough to build a company around. Ninety days to an answer.

Prepared from the Tradie AI Growth Platform business blueprint, v1.0 (19 July 2026). All financial figures in this document are illustrative models derived from stated assumptions, not observed results. The company is pre-revenue and pre-product. Market context draws on Australian Bureau of Statistics construction data and Master Builders Australia quarterly industry reporting, which should be re-verified during formal market research. Nothing here constitutes legal, financial or investment advice.